JAMES TRAVIS BACK

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Hands-on technology professional spanning IT systems and hardware, QA/test engineering, software development, automation, and technical leadership. Managed an autonomous NVIDIA GPU driver testing lab on the Microsoft campus for five years, with additional experience in software development management, mobile automation, API/database testing, virtualization, and Windows/Linux troubleshooting.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PC Technician

Link Technologies — North Las Vegas, NV | October 5, 2026 – Present

Clark County Election Department (Contract)

- Set up, configure, and test KNOWiNK Poll Pad voter sign-in systems on iPads, verifying proper operation and compliance with state and county election requirements.
- Verify system functionality and readiness before deployment to election sites.
- Deploy voter sign-in systems at designated locations throughout Clark County, preparing equipment for operational use.
- Identify, diagnose, and resolve hardware and configuration issues discovered during testing and deployment.
- Validate system operation during setup and deployment, investigate failures, and verify that identified issues have been resolved.

Slot Technician

Crawford Coin, Inc. — Henderson, NV | March 2025 – May 2026

- Serviced Aristocrat and IGT gaming machines across nearly 100 locations; diagnosed electrical, electronic, mechanical, and communication issues.
- Troubleshot communication between gaming machines, site controllers, and central office systems, including store-level infrastructure issues.
- Performed preventive, scheduled, and emergency maintenance to minimize equipment downtime and maintain reliable operation.
- Commissioned newly installed machines by verifying settings, powering equipment on, and confirming proper operation.
- Responded to service calls, independently assessed problems, documented resolutions, and maintained accurate service records.
- Performed management-requested audits of gaming safes and ATMs, physically verifying cash balances against recorded amounts and identifying discrepancies.
- Maintained authorized access to gaming machines, cash boxes, drop safes, payout safes, and ATMs while following security and cash-handling procedures.
- Supported Nevada Gaming Commission inspections by providing authorized access to gaming equipment during on-site regulatory audits.

Software Development Manager / Technical Lead

CompuOne — San Diego, CA | July 2022 – June 2024

- Led a two-developer team while remaining hands-on with C#, .NET, Blazor, Docker, CI/CD, application architecture, debugging, and code review.
- Led development of a customer-facing logistics SaaS application, modernizing a legacy VB.NET application into C#/.NET and Blazor and restructuring legacy code into maintainable components.
- Designed Docker-based development workflows and GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines automating builds and container image publication to a registry.
- Introduced Docker and Kubernetes as the development and deployment architecture in collaboration with company leadership.
- Integrated ChatGPT into the development workflow for code generation, reducing development time by up to approximately 50% based on observed development effort while reviewing and validating AI-generated code.
- Built and administered the company's initial Moodle-based cybersecurity training platform.
- Administered Kaseya Autotask workflows, automation, ticket routing, alerts, and reporting.
- Managed VMware vSphere development environments, including virtual machines, snapshots, and templates.
- Participated in technical interviews, candidate evaluation, hiring recommendations, and development of the technical interview process.

Quality Assurance Analyst
TrialCard (Eliassen Group) — Morrisville, NC | October 2021 – January 2022

- Performed manual QA testing of a web-based medication co-pay assistance application.
- Developed and executed functional test cases based on expected inputs and outputs, verifying application behavior and results.
- Performed backend data validation using SQL Server SELECT queries to verify database records and application results.
- Performed API testing using Postman, validating requests, responses, data, and expected API behavior.
- Conducted manual UI and end-to-end functional testing of web application workflows.
- Created and maintained test cases and test plans in Azure DevOps based on requirements and development changes.
- Created and tracked defects in ServiceNow, documenting issues and information needed for reproduction and resolution.
- Participated in daily Agile/Scrum stand-ups and collaborated with development and cross-functional teams.

Quality Assurance Engineer
Mobile Integration WorkGroup, Inc. — Redmond, WA | January 2019 – June 2019

- Developed and maintained automated mobile testing software and test cases for a proprietary hardware-based testing platform supporting Android and transitioning to iPhone/iOS.
- Wrote Java-based automated tests using Selenium and Appium to execute mobile workflows through the testing platform.
- Developed automated regression tests and supporting application/test code within assigned development branches.
- Performed manual and automated regression testing to validate changes, identify defects, and reproduce problems.
- Used TestRail to create and maintain test cases and test plans and Jira to manage sprint tasks, defects, and development work.
- Monitored Jenkins CI builds after code pushes to verify successful builds and ensure updated packages were available for testing.
- Troubleshot and resolved defects in both test automation and application code.

QA Test Engineer
Keywords Studios — Redmond, WA | September 2018 – January 2019

- Performed functional and exploratory testing of Valve Steam hardware and software, including HTC Vive Pro headsets, controllers, supported Steam games, Windows systems, and SteamOS-based Steam Machines.
- Executed functional test cases against hardware and software builds and performed exploratory testing to identify defects and unexpected behavior.
- Developed cross-platform C# utility tools running on Windows and Linux through Mono to collect and log system performance statistics.
- Used collected system metrics to provide diagnostic information during hardware and software testing.
- Reported test findings and potential defects to the QA lead for formal documentation and tracking.

GPU Driver Test Engineer
NVIDIA — Redmond, WA | February 2012 – March 2017

- Managed an autonomous NVIDIA GPU driver testing lab on the Microsoft campus, testing NVIDIA driver builds against Microsoft Windows OS builds and working directly with NVIDIA and Microsoft engineering teams.
- Tested NVIDIA drivers across Windows RT, Windows RT 2, Windows 8, Windows 8.1, and Windows 10, including Kepler, Maxwell, and Pascal GPUs, Tegra 3/4 platforms, and third-party hardware.
- Built and configured custom GPU test systems using varied hardware combinations to reproduce real-world PC configurations and hardware/software integration issues.
- Designed automated test-environment deployment using Batch, PowerShell, and C#, reducing lab turnover time by approximately 85%, from several days to roughly 1–2 hours.
- Automated Windows PE boot, OS/driver retrieval, WIM image modification, driver and test-script injection, deployment, and automatic stress-test initiation.
- Maintained an automated stress-testing environment designed to continuously exercise systems until failures occurred.
- Used WinDbg, including !analyze -v, to diagnose system failures and determine whether issues originated in NVIDIA drivers or Microsoft Windows components.
- Investigated NVIDIA and Microsoft bug databases, identified regressions, and worked directly with NVIDIA and Microsoft engineers to reproduce and diagnose defects.
- Developed an HTML/PHP/MySQL lab reporting system to track failures and driver/OS combinations under test.
- Maintained lab hardware, software, networking, and test environments with full operational autonomy.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Applied Science in Software Development
Green River College — Auburn, WA | March 2016 – June 2018

- 3.58 GPA, Graduated Cum Laude

Associate of Applied Science in Computing and Information Technology
College of Southern Nevada — North Las Vegas, NV | September 2001 – December 2009

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA A+ — CompTIA | Issued 2026, Expires 2029

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software Development: C#, .NET, Blazor, Java, JavaScript, VB.NET, SQL, SQL Server, PHP, MySQL, HTML/CSS, REST APIs, Git, GitHub

QA & Test Engineering: Quality Assurance, Test Automation, Manual Testing, Functional Testing, Regression Testing, Exploratory Testing, API Testing, Mobile Testing, Hardware/Software Integration Testing, Selenium, Appium, Postman, TestRail, Jira, Azure DevOps

DevOps & Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, PowerShell, Shell Scripting, Linux, VMware vSphere, Virtualization

Systems & Networking: Windows, Windows Server, Active Directory, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VLAN, Network Troubleshooting, IT Infrastructure, Hardware Troubleshooting

Debugging & Hardware: WinDbg, Kernel Debugging, Crash Analysis, GPU Testing, GPU Driver Testing, Performance Testing, System Diagnostics

Leadership: Technical Leadership, Software Development Management, Team Leadership, Project Leadership, Technical Hiring, Agile/Scrum, Process Improvement